BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #26 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

"It runs in my family, so I'm doomed."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Watching a parent or relative suffer from a disease, addiction, or mental illness can make us feel that the same fate is sealed. Family patterns are real risk factors, but risk is not destiny, and fear of fate can paralyze us.

What Scripture teaches

God told Israel, "A son will not bear the iniquity of his father" (Ezekiel 18:20), and "each is to die for his own sin" (Deuteronomy 24:16). Moses wrote that the LORD is "compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in loving devotion." Jeremiah heard, "I know the plans I have for you… plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope." Genes may raise a risk, but choices, treatment, support, and God's grace matter. Many who are at risk never develop the condition, and many who do live well with it.

> *"For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope"* (Jeremiah 29:11).

Also see

> "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him" (Ezekiel 18:20).

> "Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin" (Deuteronomy 24:16).

> "Then the LORD passed in front of Moses and called out: 'The LORD, the LORD God, is compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in loving devotion and faithfulness.'" (Exodus 34:6).

> "The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands" (Psalm 138:8).

Common self-statements

- It is in my blood.
- I will get it too.
- There is no escape.
- My family curse will find me.
- Why try to prevent it?
- I am doomed.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either have no risk or am doomed.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will repeat the family pattern.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that it is inevitable.
- Labeling: Calling myself doomed.

Challenging questions

- What does my doctor say about my actual risk?
- What steps can lower the risk or catch it early?
- What did my relative lack that I can have, such as treatment, support, or knowledge?
- Do I know family members who faced the same risk and did well?
- What does Scripture say about inherited guilt?
- What is one preventive step I can take?

Truth summary

> Risk is not destiny. God has plans for my future and hope, and I can take wise steps, get good medical advice, and trust Him with what I cannot control.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Trust
- Hopeless
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "It runs in my family, so I'm doomed"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"It runs in my family, so I'm doomed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does my doctor say about my actual risk?
- ☐ What steps can lower the risk or catch it early?
- ☐ What did my relative lack that I can have, such as treatment, support, or knowledge?
- ☐ Do I know family members who faced the same risk and did well?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about inherited guilt?
- ☐ What is one preventive step I can take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ A son will not bear his father's iniquity.
- ☐ God has plans for my future and hope.
- ☐ Risk is not destiny.
- ☐ I can take wise steps.
- ☐ God is gracious and compassionate.
- ☐ He will fulfill His purpose for me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Jeremiah 29:11
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."
- ☐ Ezekiel 18:20
  "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him."
- ☐ Deuteronomy 24:16
  "Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Wise steps: Each month, note one healthy or preventive step you took.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Jeremiah 29:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God has plans for my future and hope.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Learn your actual risk. Ask your doctor about screening and prevention.
- [ ] Build healthy habits. Sleep, move, eat well, and reduce harmful substances.
- [ ] Get support. Talk to a counselor if fear dominates.
- [ ] Memorize Jeremiah 29:11. Say it when fear rises.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "It runs in my family, so I'm doomed": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Wise steps
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~It runs in my family, so I'm doomed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear what runs in my family. Give me wisdom, wise doctors, and trust that my future is in Your hands. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #27 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

"I'll end up just like my parent."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Seeing a parent struggle with addiction, anger, depression, or illness, we may be terrified of repeating their path. Others tell us, "You're just like your father," and we may start acting as if the script is already written.

What Scripture teaches

"The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son." "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17). "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind" (Romans 12:2). You can learn from a parent's pain what to avoid. Your life is your own to live with God's help.

> *"The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him"* (Ezekiel 18:20).

Also see

> "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin" (Deuteronomy 24:16).

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11).

Common self-statements

- I am just like them.
- I cannot escape their pattern.
- I will make the same mistakes.
- It is in my nature.
- People expect me to turn out like them.
- I am destined to repeat it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either unlike my parent or identical.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will repeat their life.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling the pull and concluding it is inevitable.
- Labeling: Calling myself a copy.

Challenging questions

- In what ways am I different from my parent?
- What did my parent lack that I can have?
- What exactly do I fear repeating?
- What choices can I make differently?
- Who could support me, like a counselor, mentor, or pastor?
- What does Scripture say about being a new creation?

Truth summary

> I am not my parent. I am a new creation in Christ, and I can choose differently, learn from their story, and receive support. My life is not a repeat.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Thinking, Unhealthy
- Fear
- Parenting
- Hopeless
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Death and Dying

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll end up just like my parent"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll end up just like my parent." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ In what ways am I different from my parent?
- ☐ What did my parent lack that I can have?
- ☐ What exactly do I fear repeating?
- ☐ What choices can I make differently?
- ☐ Who could support me, like a counselor, mentor, or pastor?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about being a new creation?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am a new creation.
- ☐ The son does not bear the father's iniquity.
- ☐ My mind can be renewed.
- ☐ I can choose differently.
- ☐ Support is available.
- ☐ God has a future for me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ezekiel 18:20
  "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"
- ☐ Romans 12:2
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A different path: Each week, note one choice that differs from the pattern.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Ezekiel 18:20 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am a new creation in Christ.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Thinking, Unhealthy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List differences. Write how you are not like your parent.
- [ ] Name the fear. Write what you want to avoid.
- [ ] Make a plan. Choose one concrete safeguard.
- [ ] Find support. Counseling or a mentor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll end up just like my parent": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A different path
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll end up just like my parent.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I fear repeating the past. Make me new, give me wisdom to choose differently, and surround me with support. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“I was born defective.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A birth condition, learning difference, or inherited trait can feel like proof that we came into the world flawed. Comparisons, medical language, and remarks from others can deepen the feeling of being a mistake.

What Scripture teaches

“For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb.” God said to Jeremiah, “Before I formed you in the womb I knew you.” When the disciples asked about a man born blind, Jesus said, “Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.” God asked Moses, “Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?” You are not a mistake. God knew you, formed you, and has a purpose for you.

> *“For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb”* (Psalm 139:13).

Also see

> “‘Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.’” (Jeremiah 1:5).

> “Jesus answered, ‘Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.’” (John 9:3).

> “And the LORD said to him, ‘Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?’” (Exodus 4:11).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- I was made wrong.
- I am a mistake.
- Something went wrong with me from the start.
- I was never meant to be.
- God made a bad batch.
- I have always been broken.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either made perfectly or defective.
- Fortune telling: Predicting a life of limitation.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I was made wrong.
- Labeling: Calling myself defective.

Challenging questions

- Who first called me defective?

- What does God say about how I was formed?
- What gifts do I have that go along with how I was made?
- What purposes might God have for me?
- What would I say to a baby born with my condition?
- Who sees me as valuable?

Truth summary

> God formed me and knew me before I was born. I am not a mistake. My life has purpose, and His works can be displayed in me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame
- Suffering
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I was born defective"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I was born defective." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who first called me defective?
- ☐ What does God say about how I was formed?
- ☐ What gifts do I have that go along with how I was made?
- ☐ What purposes might God have for me?
- ☐ What would I say to a baby born with my condition?
- ☐ Who sees me as valuable?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knit me together.
- ☐ He knew me before I was born.
- ☐ God's works can be displayed in me.
- ☐ God made me as I am.
- ☐ I am not a mistake.
- ☐ My life has purpose.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 139:13**
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb."
- ☐ **Jeremiah 1:5**
  "'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.'"
- ☐ **John 9:3**
  "Jesus answered, 'Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Made on purpose: Each week, note one strength or purpose that is part of you.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God formed me and knew me before I was born.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ List your gifts. Write what you do well.
- ☐ Name the source. Write who called you defective.
- ☐ Read Psalm 139. Mark each line that speaks of your making.
- ☐ Tell someone. Share how you feel.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I was born defective": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Made on purpose
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I was born defective.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Creator God, You knit me together and knew me before I was born. Heal my sense of being a mistake and show me Your purpose for me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #29 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

“It's in my genes, so there's no point trying.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When a condition has a genetic component, some conclude that effort, treatment, and habits are pointless. This fatalism can keep people from the very steps that help.

What Scripture teaches

“Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.” “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed.” God invites us to be wise stewards of the bodies and minds He gave. Genes load the dice but do not decide every roll. Diet, sleep, exercise, therapy, medication, and relationships often change outcomes significantly. “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

> *“Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up”* (Galatians 6:9).

Also see

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

> “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

> “Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast and immovable. Always excel in the work of the Lord, because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain” (1 Corinthians 15:58).

> “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel” (Proverbs 12:15).

Common self-statements

- Nothing I do will make a difference.
- Genes decide everything.
- Effort is wasted.
- I may as well give up.
- Why bother with treatment?
- I cannot change my biology.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing outcomes are either all genes or all effort.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that effort will fail.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling helpless and concluding that effort is useless.
- Labeling: Calling myself a victim of my genes.

Challenging questions

- What does my doctor say about what can be done?
- What lifestyle or treatment steps help even with a genetic risk?
- Do I know people who managed well despite genetics?
- What would trying look like in a small way?

- What does Scripture say about not giving up?
- Who can help me stay motivated?

Truth summary

> Genes are one factor, not the whole story. Wise effort, good care, and God's help matter. I can take small steps and not give up.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Laziness
- Faith
- Wisdom
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "It's in my genes, so there's no point trying"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"It's in my genes, so there's no point trying." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does my doctor say about what can be done?
- ☐ What lifestyle or treatment steps help even with a genetic risk?
- ☐ Do I know people who managed well despite genetics?
- ☐ What would trying look like in a small way?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about not giving up?
- ☐ Who can help me stay motivated?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Effort is not wasted.
- ☐ I will not grow weary.
- ☐ Many advisers help.
- ☐ I can do all things through Christ.
- ☐ Small steps count.
- ☐ God works with my effort.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:9
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."
- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."
- ☐ Philippians 4:13
  "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Doing what I can: Each week, note one helpful step you took.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Galatians 6:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Ask your doctor. Learn what helps for your condition.
- ☐ Pick one habit. Sleep, movement, or nutrition.
- ☐ Track progress. Write what changes.
- ☐ Pray Galatians 6:9. Ask for perseverance.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "It's in my genes, so there's no point trying": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Doing what I can
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~It's in my genes, so there's no point trying.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel that nothing matters. Give me wisdom to do what I can, strength to keep going, and trust that You work in my effort. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #30 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

“I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Parents with inherited conditions often carry deep guilt about the possibility of passing them on. Some avoid having children, and some blame themselves for a child’s struggles.

What Scripture teaches

“Children are indeed a heritage from the LORD, and the fruit of the womb is His reward.” “From everlasting to everlasting the loving devotion of the LORD extends to those who fear Him, and His righteousness to their children’s children.” A child’s life is in God’s hands, not only in genetics. Many children of parents with conditions are loved, helped, and flourish, and you can model faith and resilience. Guilt is not required of you. Love, honesty, and good care are.

> *“Children are indeed a heritage from the LORD, and the fruit of the womb is His reward”* (Psalm 127:3).

Also see

> “But from everlasting to everlasting the loving devotion of the LORD extends to those who fear Him, and His righteousness to their children’s children” (Psalm 103:17).

> “Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not depart from it” (Proverbs 22:6).

> “The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him” (Ezekiel 18:20).

> “‘Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you! Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me.’” (Isaiah 49:15–16).

Common self-statements

- It is my fault if they struggle.
- I should not have had children.
- I have doomed them.
- They will suffer because of me.
- I cannot forgive myself.
- I am a bad parent.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either a perfect parent or a harmful one.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that my children will suffer.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that I harmed them.
- Personalization: Calling myself a ruiner.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I fear for my children?
- What strengths and love am I also passing on?
- What help and treatment would my children have available?
- Have I shared honestly with them at the right level?
- What does Scripture say about children and God's care?
- Whom can I talk to about my guilt?

Truth summary

> My children are God's heritage and in His care. I pass on love, faith, and resilience as well as genes. I can seek good care for them and release guilt that is not mine to carry.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Parenting
- Guilt/Shame
- Fear
- Trust
- God, All Loving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

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God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives"

✦ ✦ ✦

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Name: _____ Date started: _____

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Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly do I fear for my children?
- ☐ What strengths and love am I also passing on?
- ☐ What help and treatment would my children have available?
- ☐ Have I shared honestly with them at the right level?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about children and God's care?
- ☐ Whom can I talk to about my guilt?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Children are a heritage from the LORD.
- ☐ God's love reaches their children's children.
- ☐ I pass on love and faith too.
- ☐ Guilt is not mine to carry.
- ☐ God cares for my children.
- ☐ I can seek good help.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 127:3**
  "Children are indeed a heritage from the LORD, and the fruit of the womb is His reward."
- ☐ **Psalm 103:17**
  "But from everlasting to everlasting the loving devotion of the LORD extends to those who fear Him, and His righteousness to their children's children."
- ☐ **Proverbs 22:6**
  "Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not depart from it."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Love passed on: Each week, note one way you showed love or faith to your child.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 127:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My children are a heritage from the Lord.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
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6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

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- [ ] List what you give. Write the strengths you pass on.
- [ ] Be honest. Talk with your children in age-appropriate ways.
- [ ] Seek help early. Work with doctors and counselors.
- [ ] Pray for your children. Entrust them to God daily.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

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THE LIE

~~I'll pass this on and ruin my children's lives.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I fear for my children. Forgive my guilt, hold them in Your care, and help me pass on love and faith. Amen.

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